



US 20250275520A1

(19) **United States**

(12) **Patent Application Publication**
Wilhelm et al.

(10) **Pub. No.: US 2025/0275520 A1**

(43) **Pub. Date: Sep. 4, 2025**

(54) **PET TOY**

Publication Classification

(71) Applicant: **DOSKOCIL MANUFACTURING COMPANY, INC.**, Arlington, TX (US)

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01K 15/02 (2006.01)
B29C 65/00 (2006.01)
B29K 75/00 (2006.01)
B29L 31/52 (2006.01)

(72) Inventors: **Josiah Wilhelm**, Fort Worth, TX (US); **Ronald Bagley**, Dallas, TX (US); **Chris Wilson**, Arlington, TX (US); **Sunil Pinto**, Arlington, TX (US)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **A01K 15/025** (2013.01); **B29C 66/727** (2013.01); **B29K 2075/00** (2013.01); **B29L 2031/52** (2013.01)

(73) Assignee: **DOSKOCIL MANUFACTURING COMPANY, INC.**, Arlington, TX (US)

(21) Appl. No.: **19/212,447**

(22) Filed: **May 19, 2025**

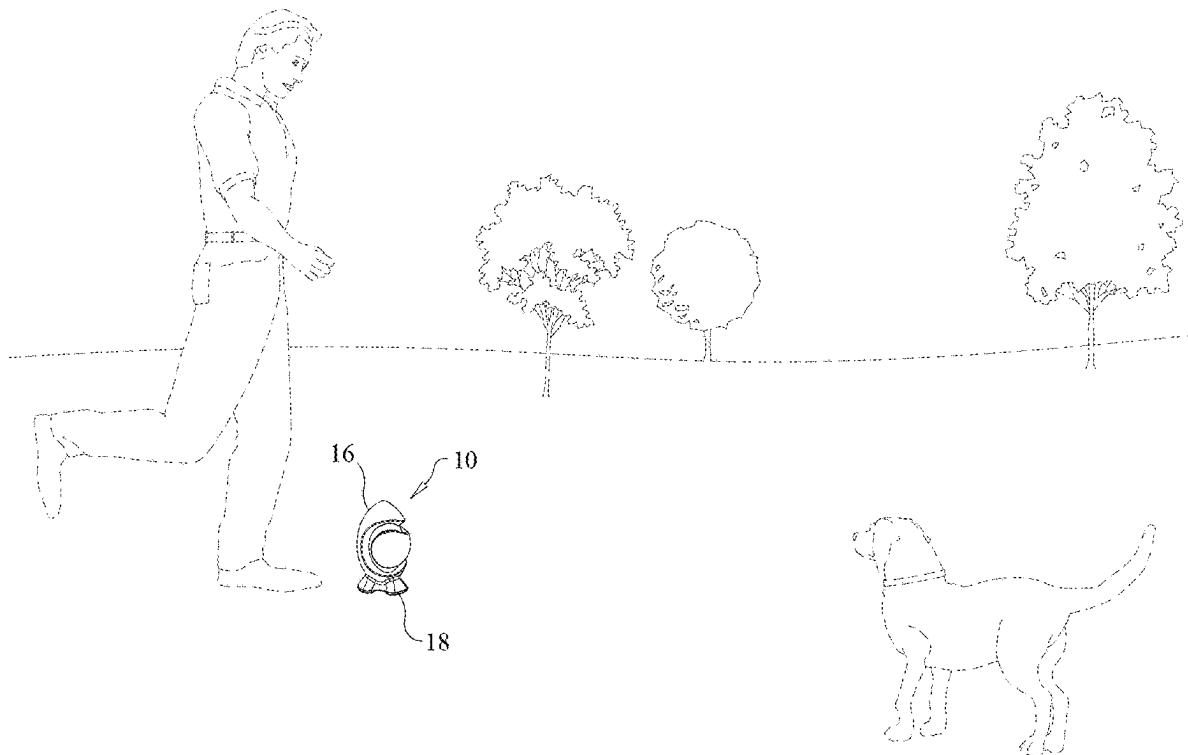
Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 17/392,345, filed on Aug. 3, 2021, now Pat. No. 12,302,862.

(60) Provisional application No. 63/164,021, filed on Mar. 22, 2021.

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A pet toy includes a body having a center and a foot portion. The foot portion is coupled to and extends from the body. The foot portion includes a plurality of fins coupled to the body and extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the body. Each of the plurality of fins includes a distal end adapted to contact a support surface when the pet toy is positioned in a substantially upright position relative to a support surface, the plurality of fins being arranged and dimensioned so that a force applied user's foot to at least one fin of the plurality of fins is configured to cause the pet toy to move from a non-upright position to the substantially upright position.



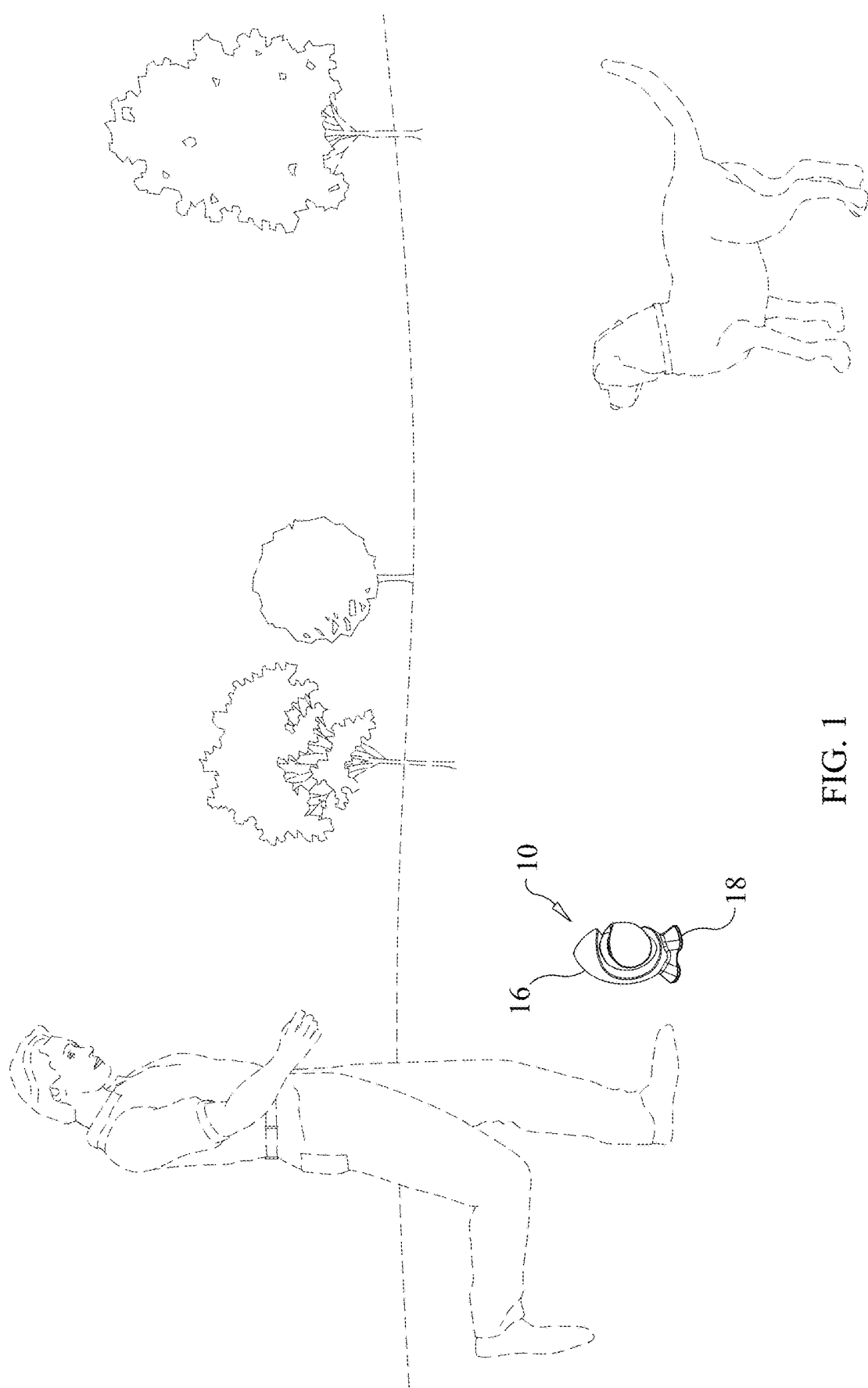


FIG. 1

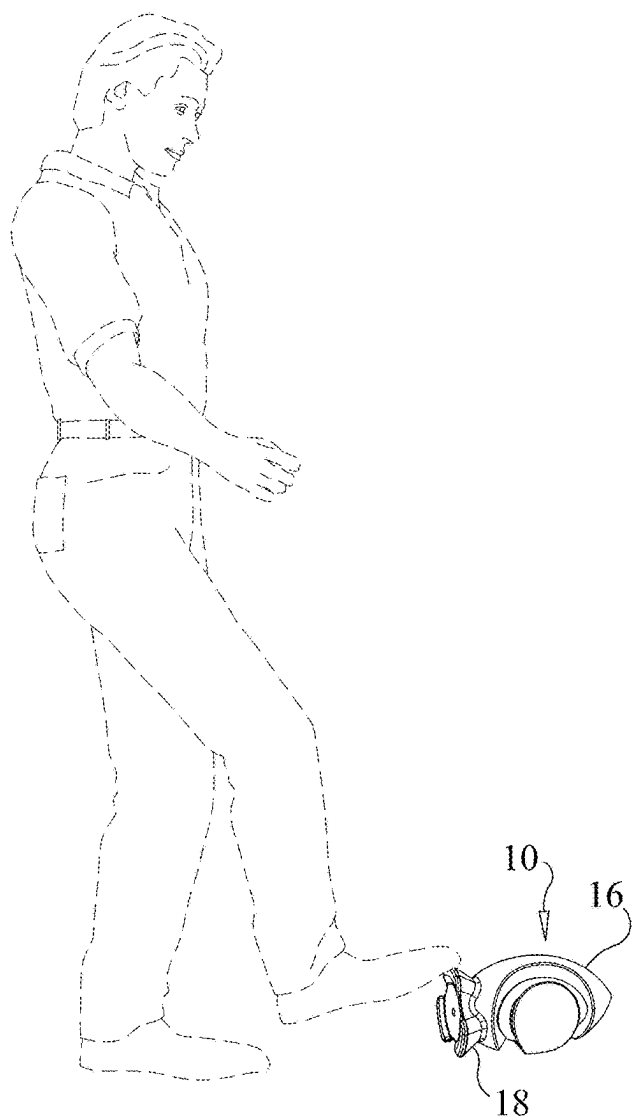


FIG. 2

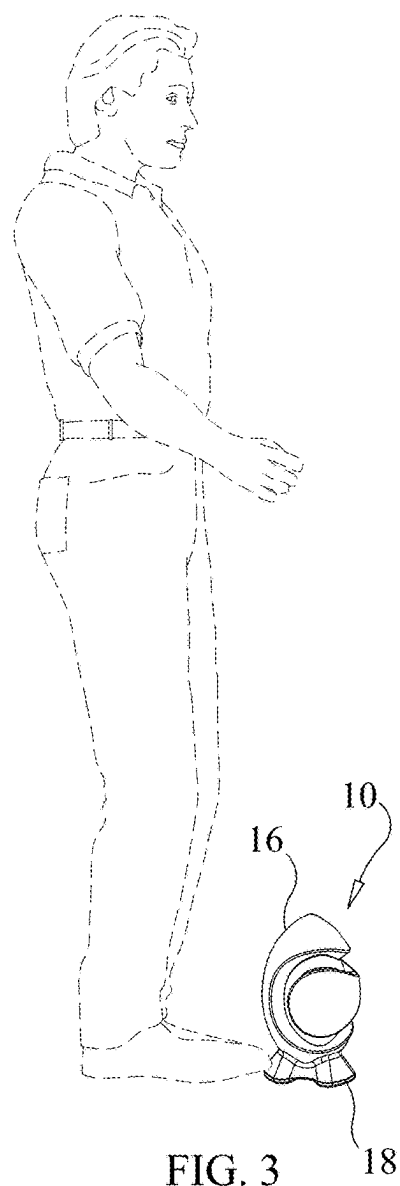
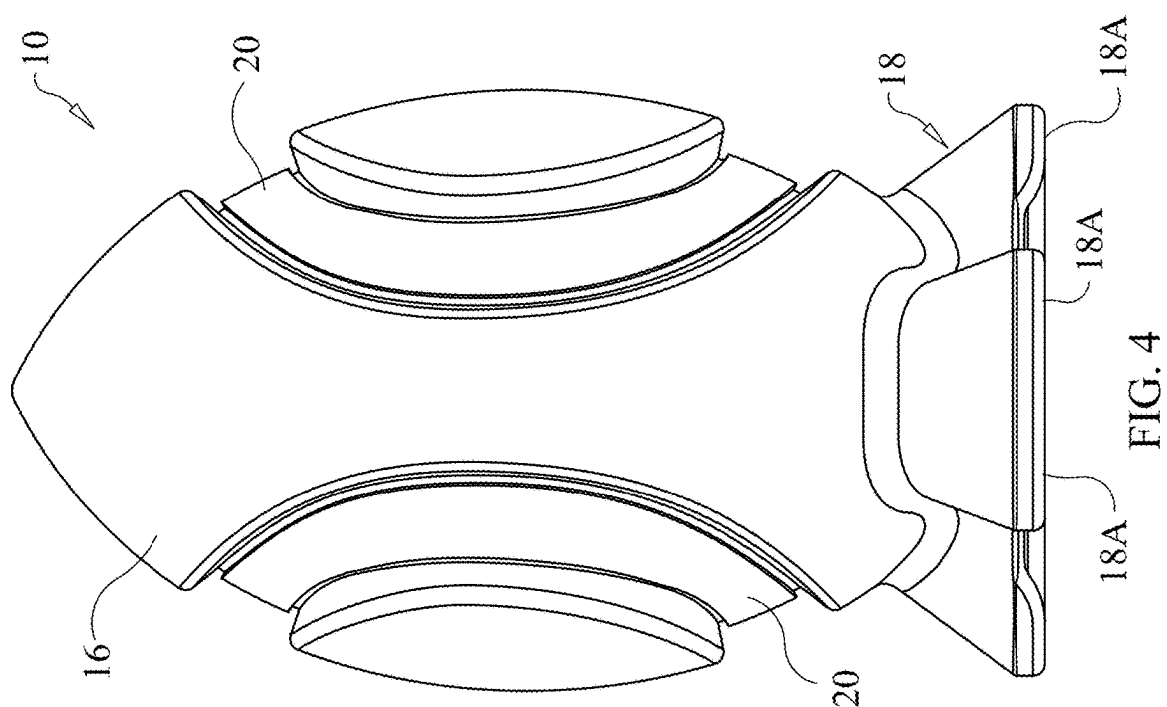
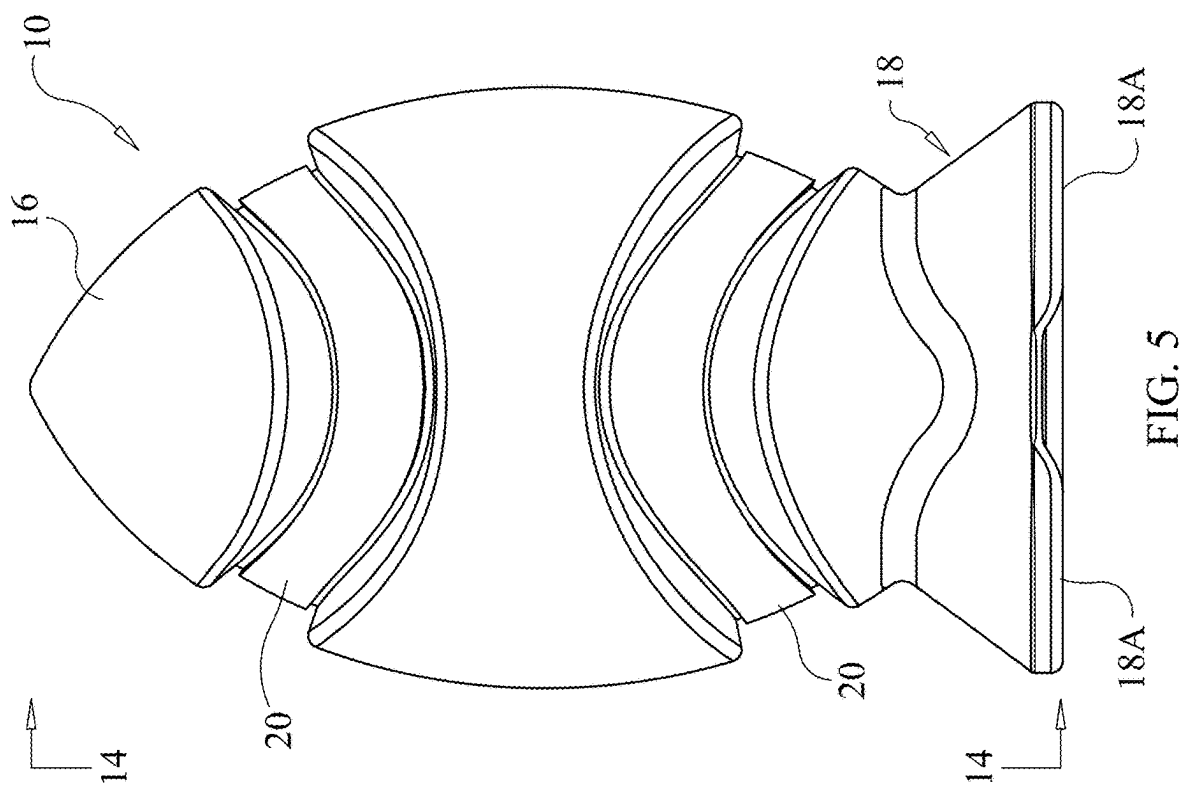


FIG. 3



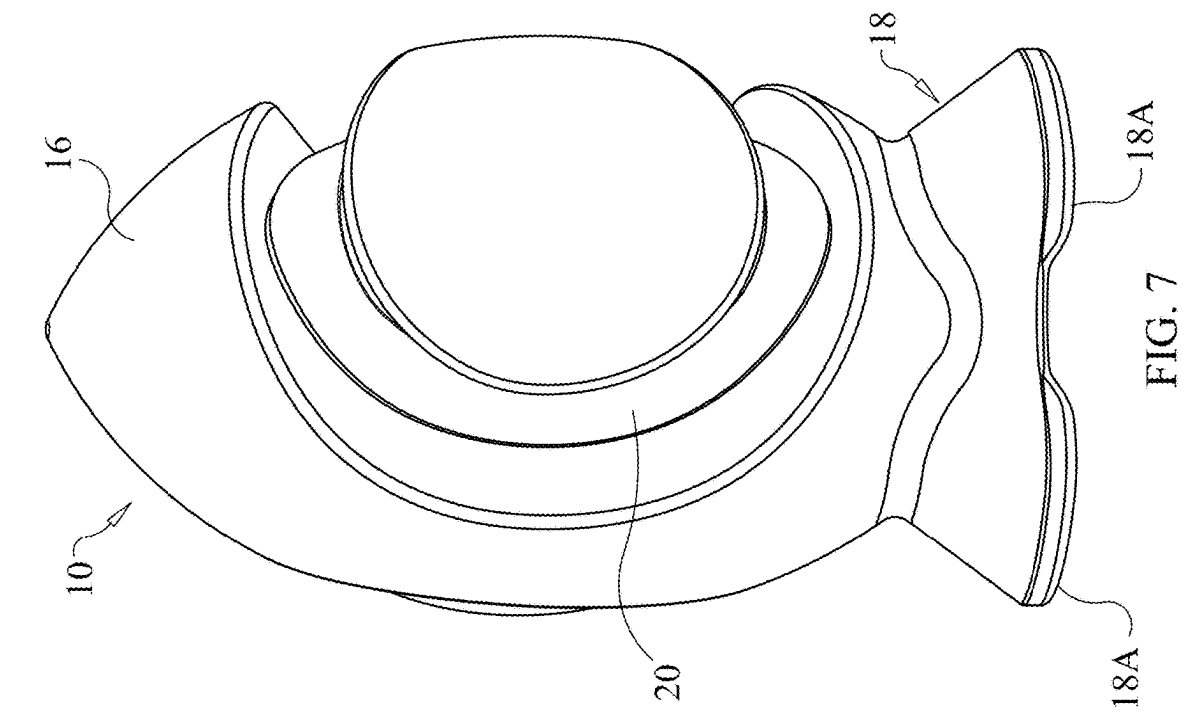


FIG. 6

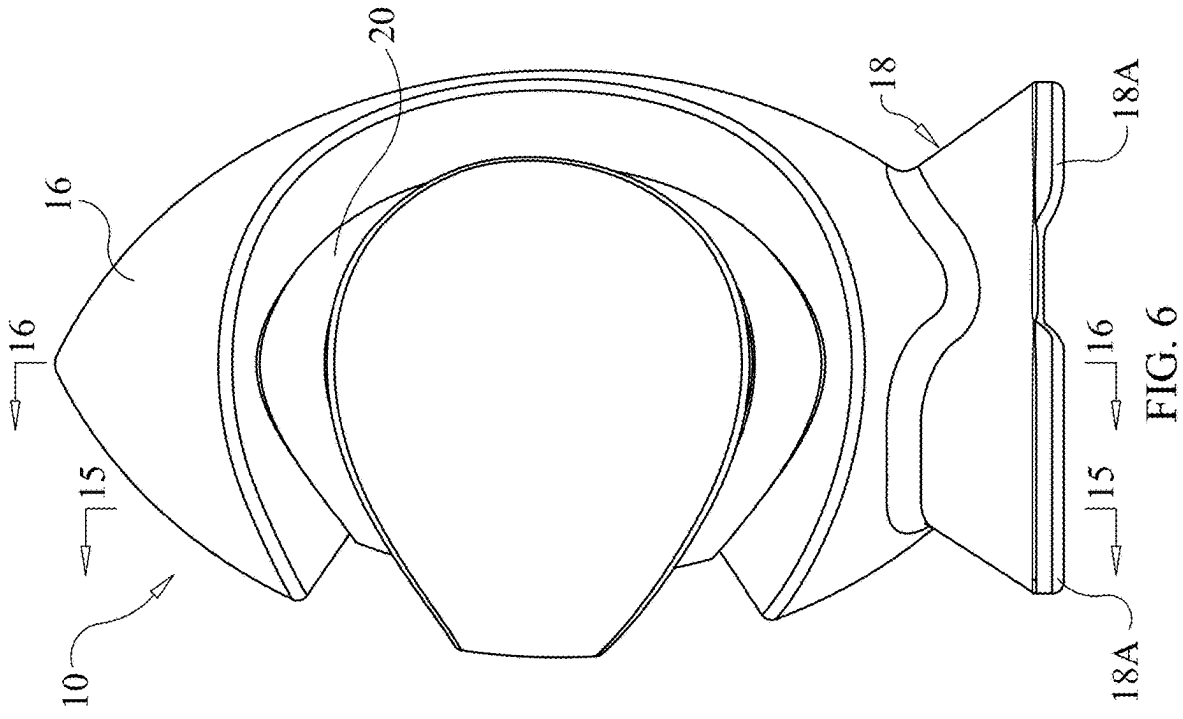


FIG. 7

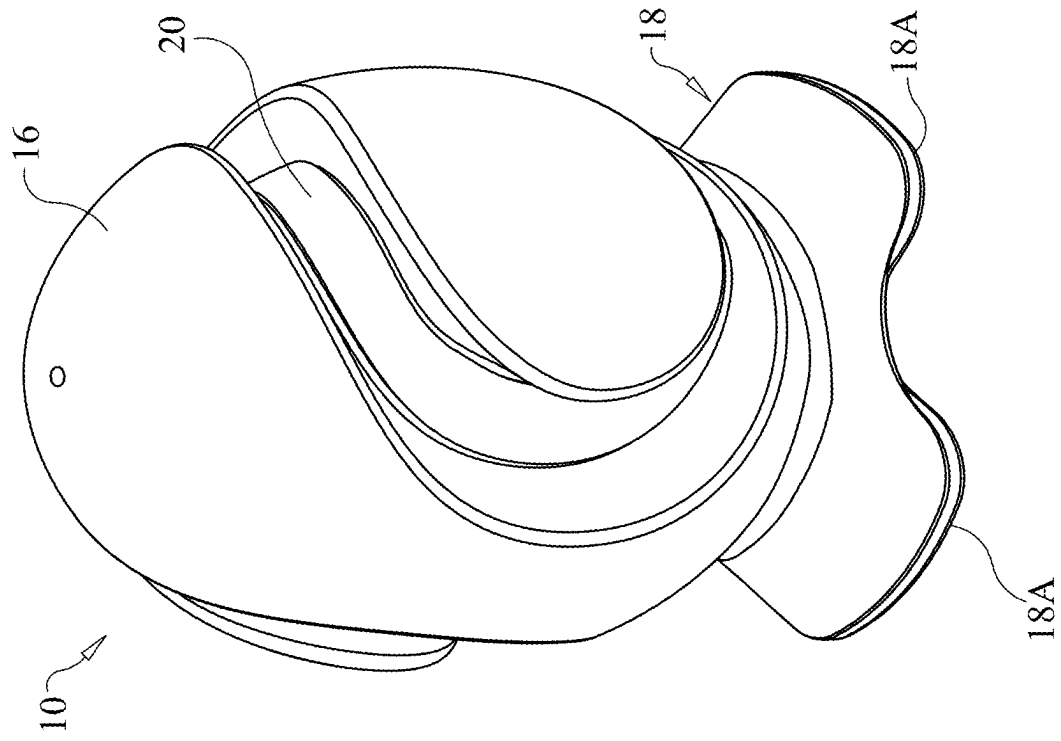


FIG. 8

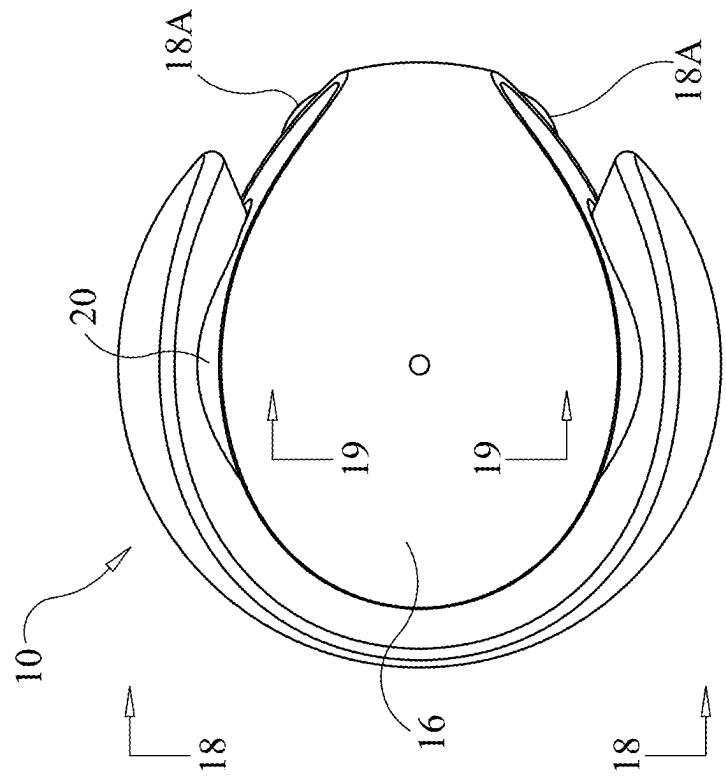


FIG. 9

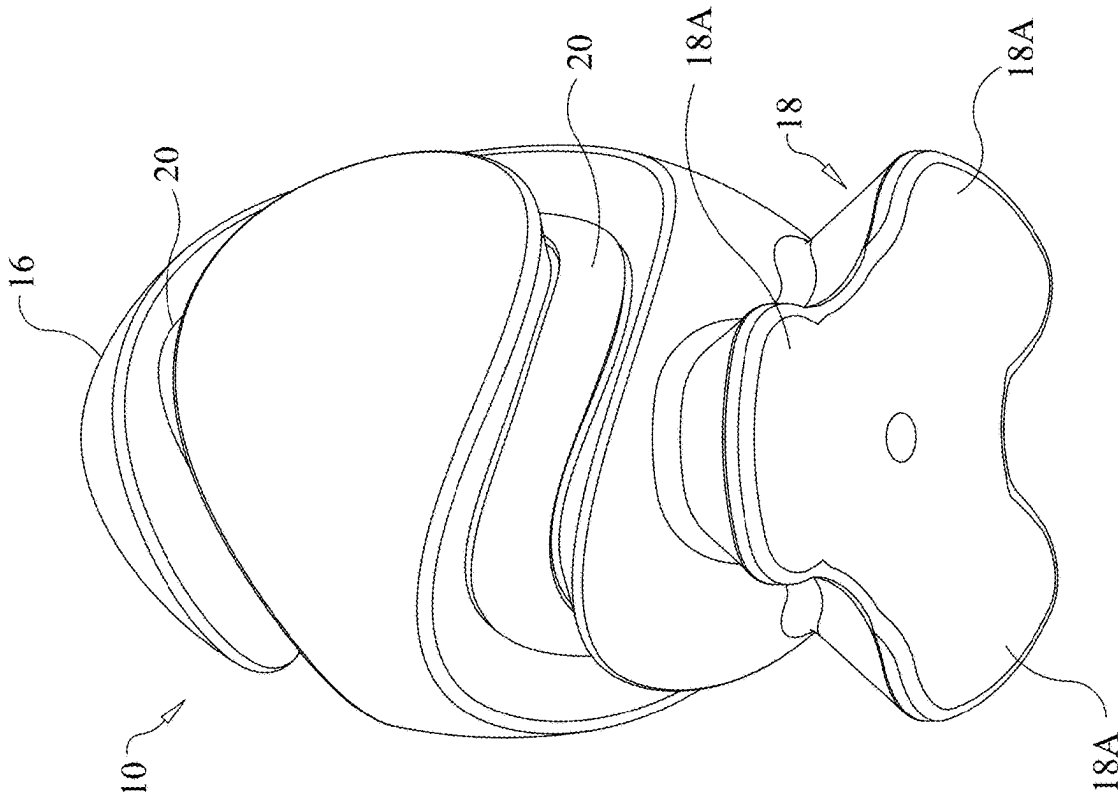


FIG. 10

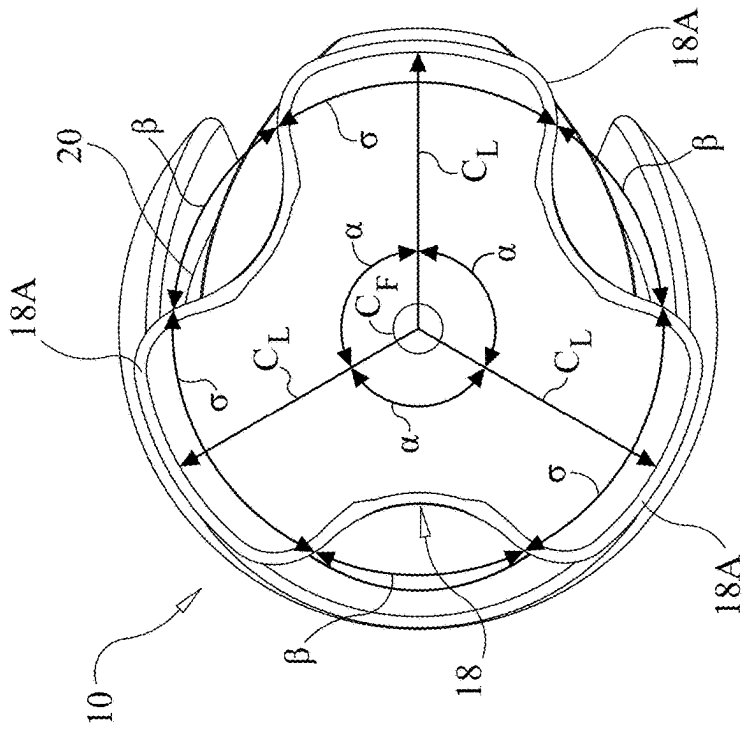


FIG. 11

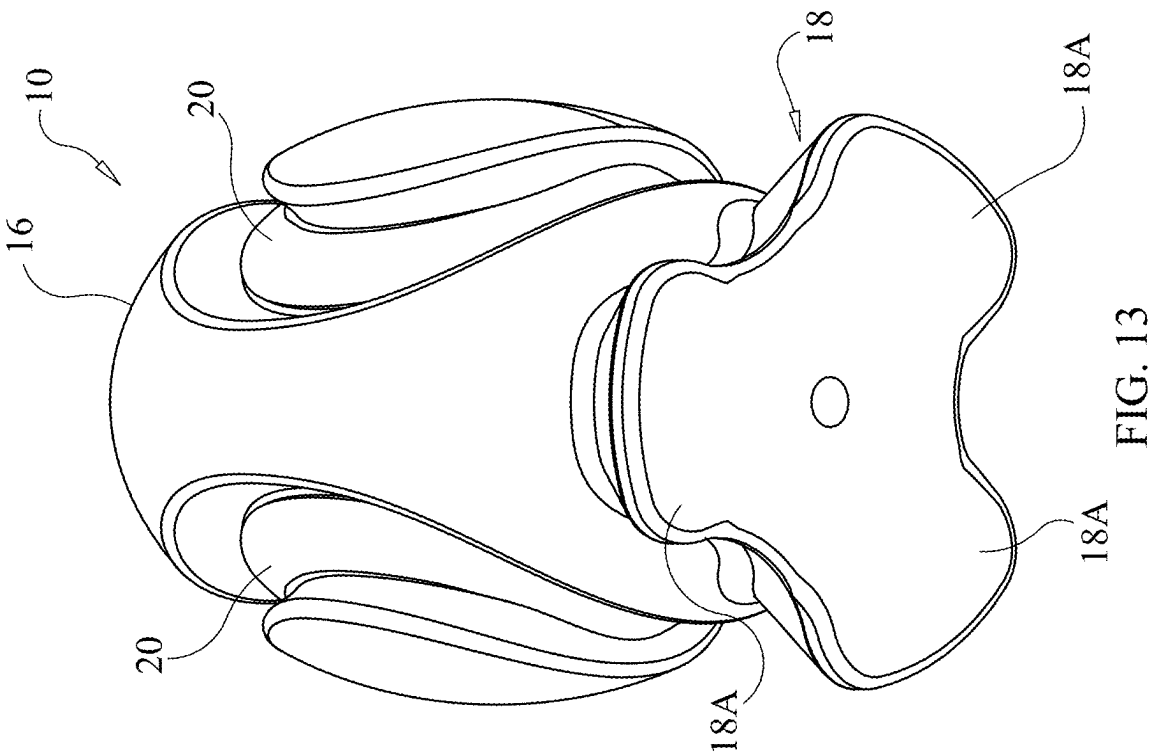


FIG. 12

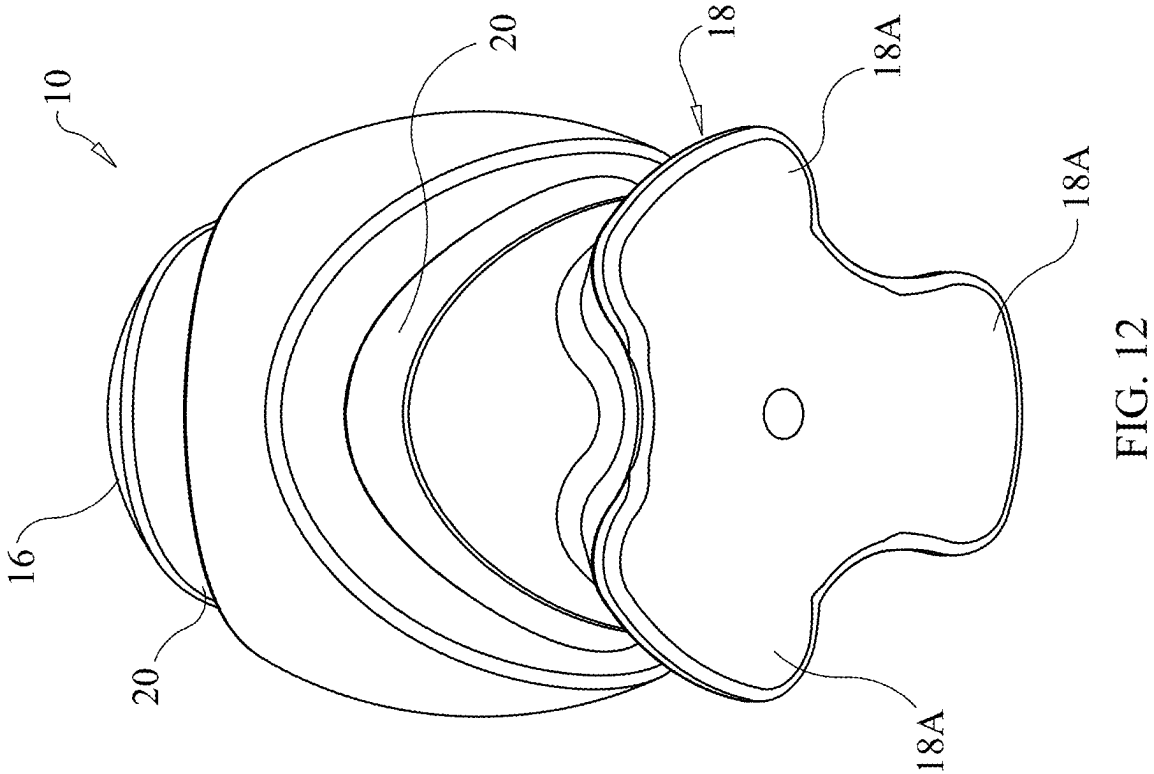


FIG. 13

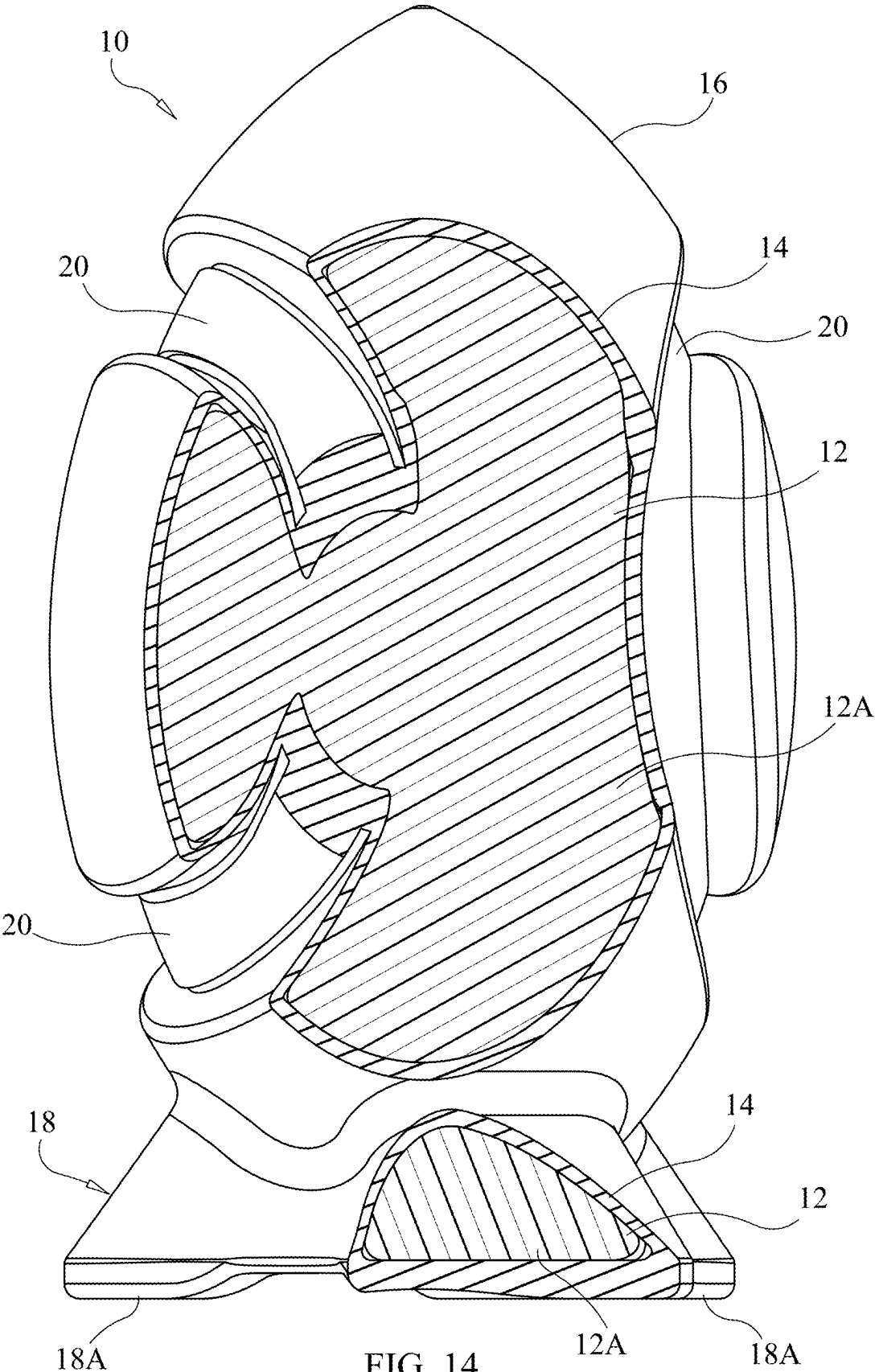
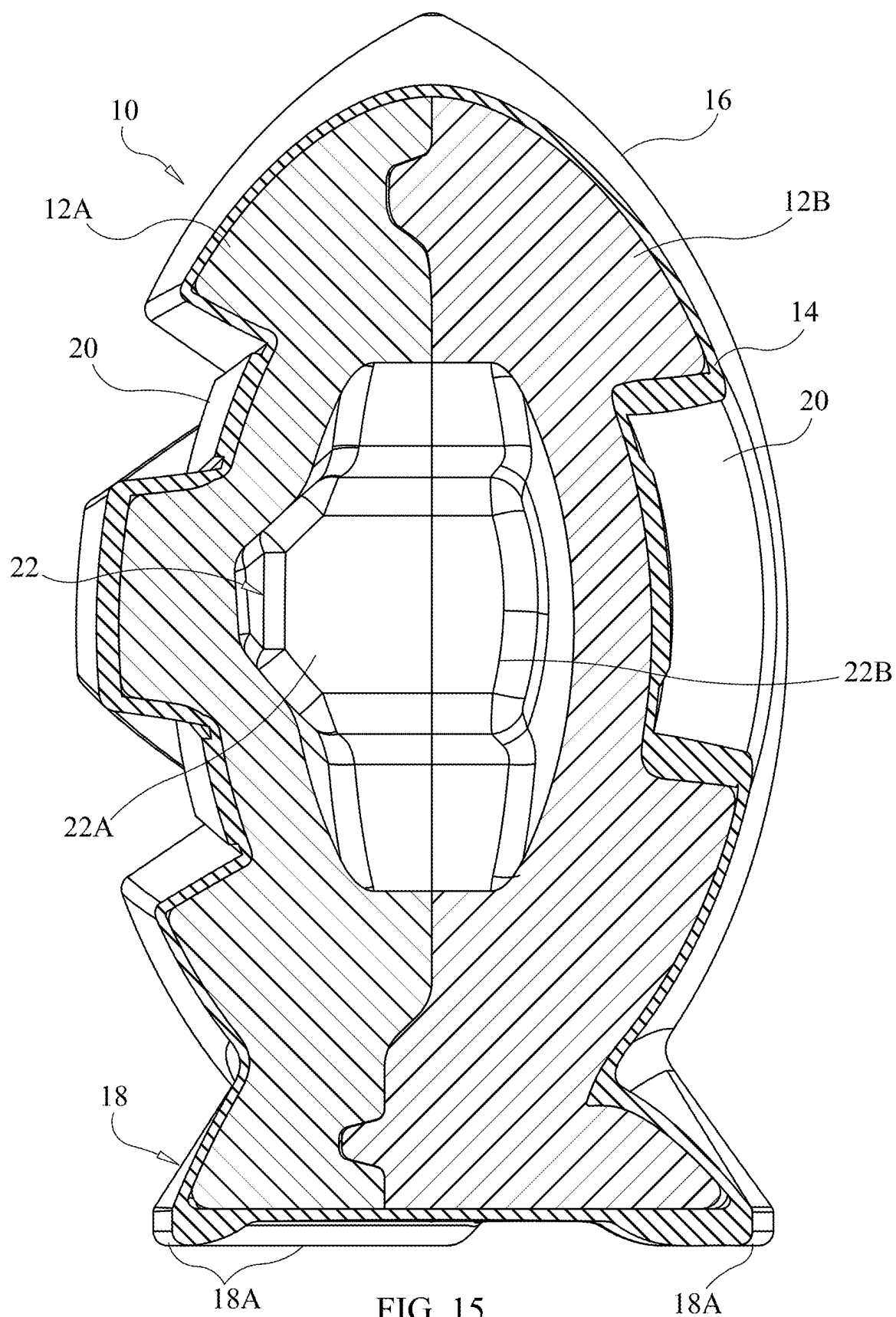


FIG. 14



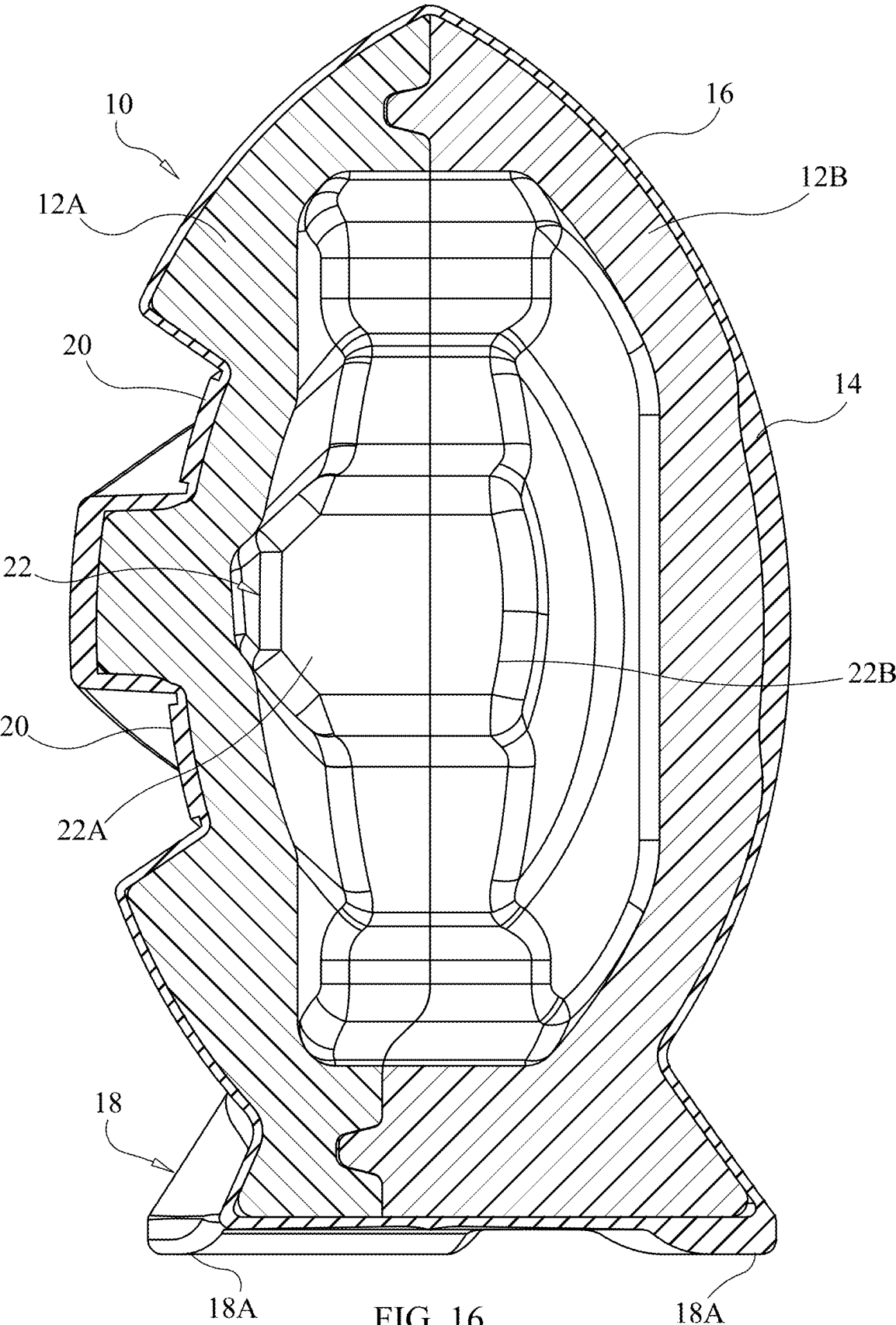


FIG. 16

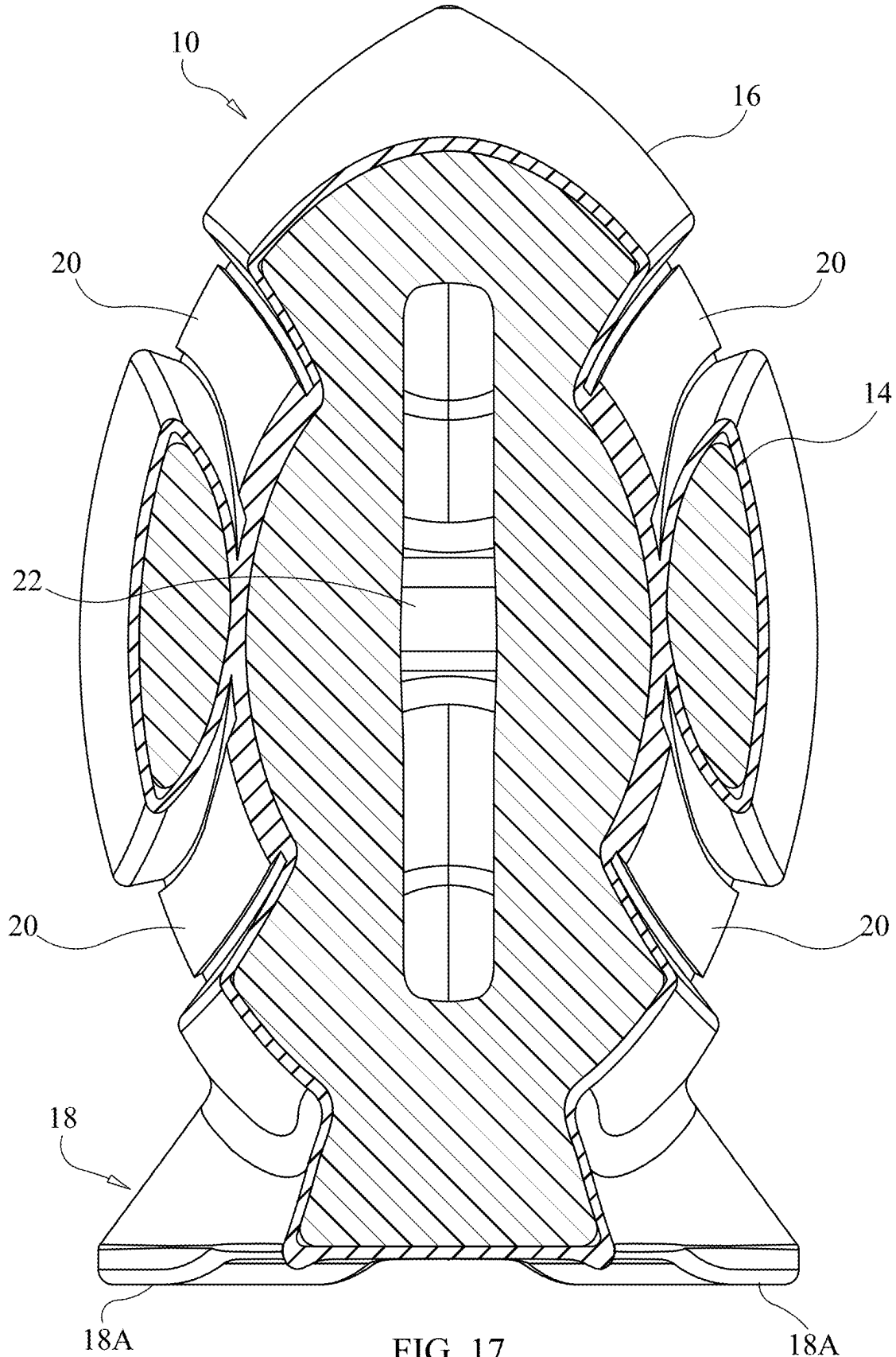


FIG. 17

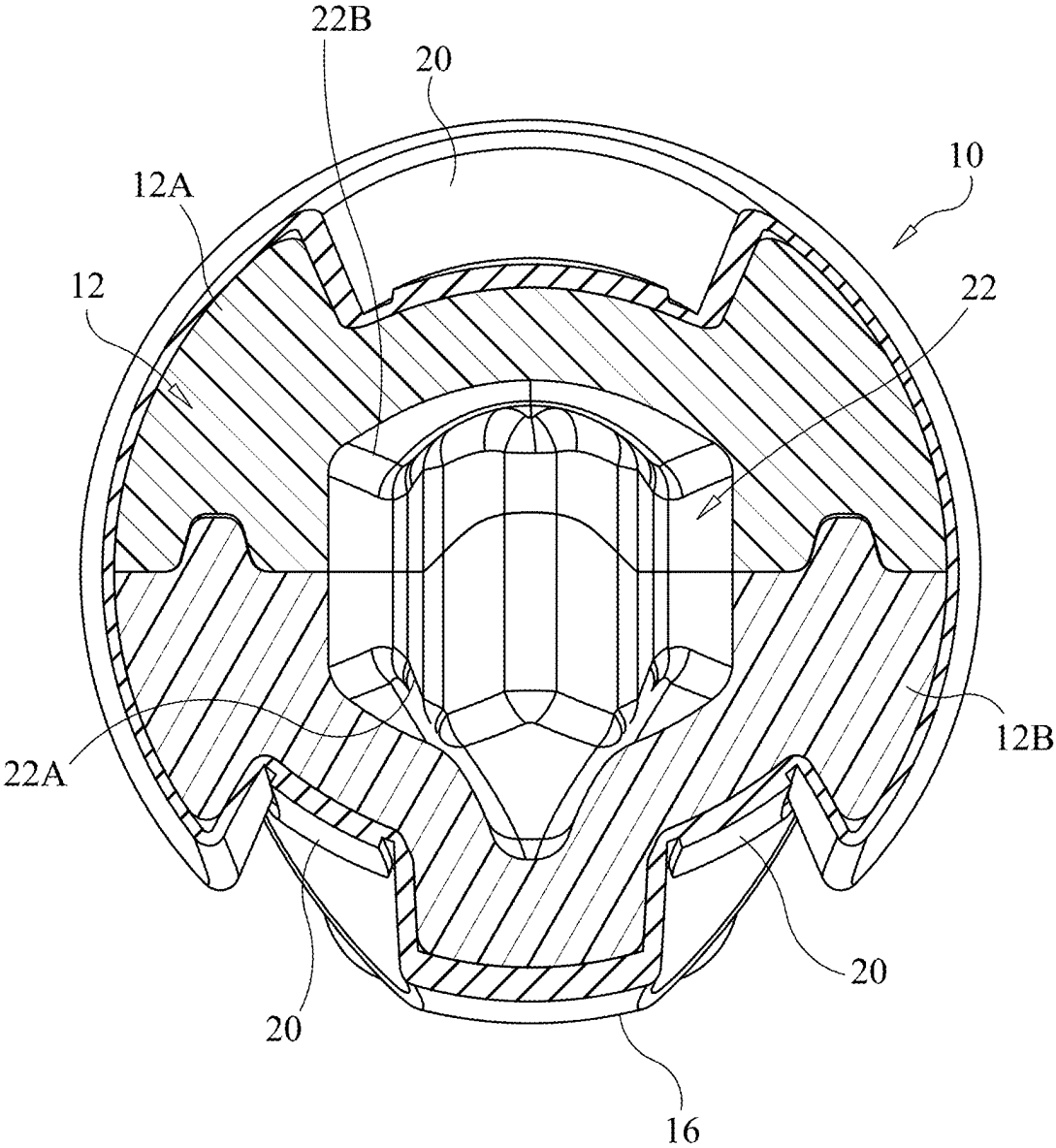


FIG. 18

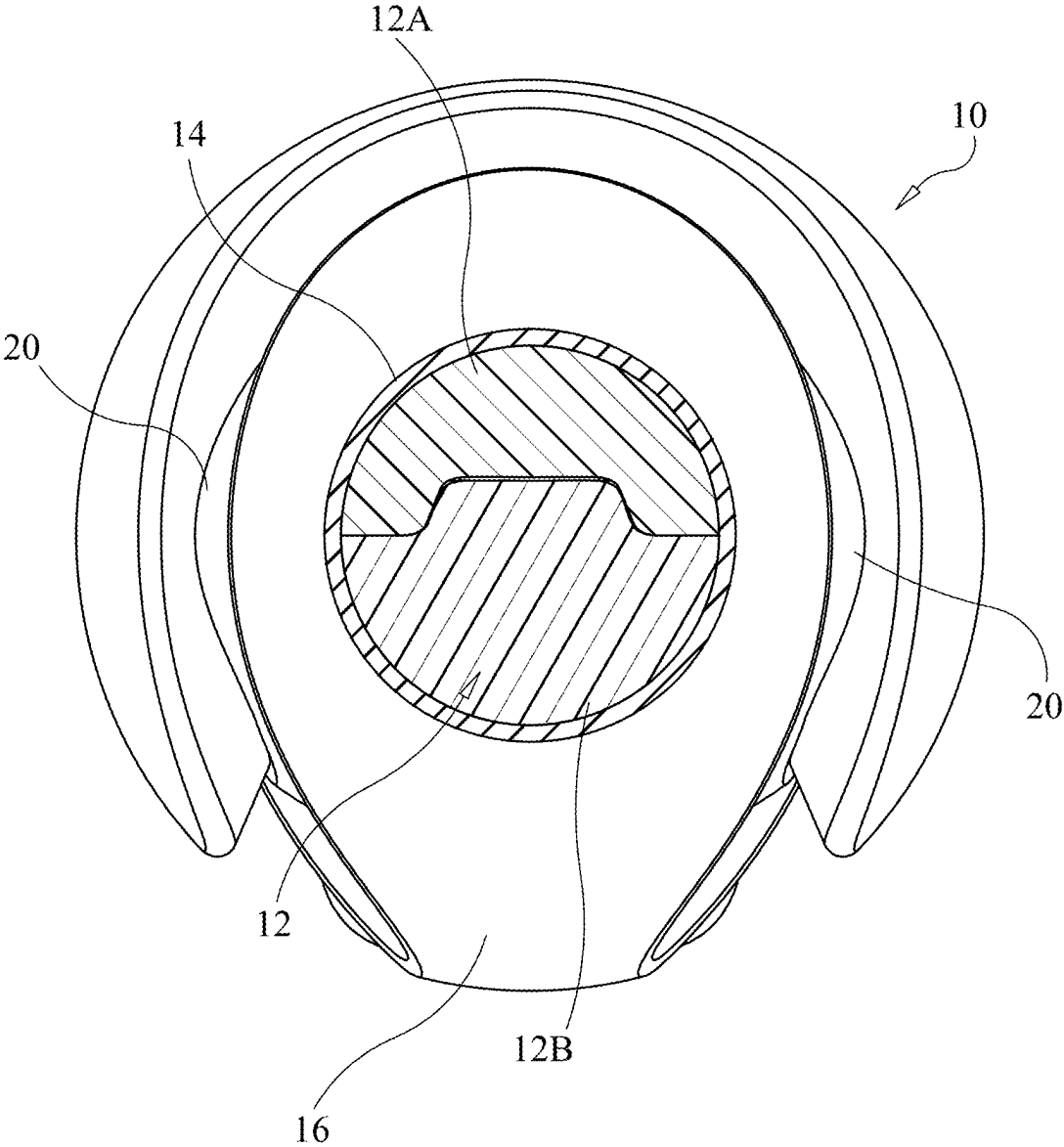


FIG. 19

PET TOY

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/392,345, filed Aug. 3, 2021, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/164,021, filed on Mar. 22, 2021, both of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

[0002] The present invention generally relates to a pet toy. More specifically, the present invention relates to a pet toy made of different materials such that it is durable, yet soft and light.

[0003] Conventional large pet toys that are designed to be lightweight are typically made out of hard plastic or are formed by methods such as blow molding or roto-molding components together. Further, typical throw toys require the user to pick up the toy in order to launch the pet toy into the air so that the pet can chase after the pet toy.

SUMMARY

[0004] In one embodiment, a pet toy includes a body having a center and a foot portion. The foot portion is coupled to and extends from the body. The foot portion includes a plurality of fins coupled to the body and extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the body. Each of the plurality of fins includes a distal end adapted to contact a support surface when the pet toy is positioned in a substantially upright position relative to a support surface. The plurality of fins are arranged and dimensioned so that a force applied user's foot to at least one fin of the plurality of fins is configured to cause the pet toy to move from a non-upright position to the substantially upright position.

[0005] In another embodiment, a pet toy includes a spheroid portion having a center and a foot portion. The foot portion is integrally coupled to the spheroid portion. The foot portion includes a plurality of fins coupled to the spheroid portion. The plurality of fins extend substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the spheroid portion and define a recessed surface therebetween. Each fin of the plurality of fins including a distal end extending away from the recessed surface. The distal ends of a first fin and a second fin of the plurality of fins are adapted to contact a support surface with the pet toy in a non-upright position. A third fin of the plurality of fins is arranged and dimensioned to extend substantially upward with the pet toy in the non-upright position. The third fin is adapted to receive a force applied by a user's foot to move the pet toy from the non-upright position to a substantially upright position.

[0006] In yet another embodiment, a method of manufacturing a pet toy includes forming a body of the pet toy, the body having a center. The method further includes forming a foot portion integrally coupled to the body, the foot portion forming a stand for the body to position the pet toy in a substantially upright position relative to a support surface. The foot portion includes a plurality of fins coupled to the body and extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the body. Each of the plurality of fins includes a distal end adapted to contact a support

surface when the pet toy is positioned in the substantially upright position. The plurality of fins are arranged and dimensioned so that a force applied by a user's foot to at least one fin of the plurality of fins is configured to cause the pet toy to move from a non-upright position to the substantially upright position.

[0007] In view of the state of the known technology, it has been determined that an improved pet toy is desired. A first aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a pet toy comprising a core body and a coating layer. The core body is made of a first material. The core body includes a first core body member and a second core body member that are mated together to have a space therebetween. The coating layer covers the core body. The coating layer is made of a second material that is different from the first material.

[0008] In a second aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the first aspect, the first material has a first density. The coating layer has a second density that is greater than the first density.

[0009] In a third aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the first aspect, the first material includes polyurethane foam.

[0010] In a fourth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the third aspect, the second material includes liquid rubber that is applied and cured to the first material.

[0011] In a fifth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the fourth aspect, the first core body member is a first polyurethane foam. The second core body member is a second polyurethane foam that are mated together.

[0012] In a sixth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the fifth aspect, the pet toy further comprises a cavity defining the space separating a portion of the first polyurethane foam and a portion of the second polyurethane foam

[0013] A seventh aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a pet toy comprising a spheroid portion and a foot portion. The foot portion is integrally attached to the spheroid portion. The foot portion has a flat surface that forms a stand for the spheroid portion.

[0014] In an eighth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the seventh aspect, the spheroid portion includes a first polyurethane foam and a second polyurethane foam that are mated together.

[0015] In a ninth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the eighth aspect, the foot portion includes the first and second polyurethane foam

[0016] In a tenth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the eighth aspect, the pet toy further comprises a space separating a portion of the first polyurethane foam and a portion of the second polyurethane foam in the spheroid portion.

[0017] In an eleventh aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the tenth aspect, the foot portion has a first density of the pet toy. The spheroid portion has a second density of the pet toy. The first density is greater than the second density.

[0018] In a twelfth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the eleventh aspect, the pet toy further comprises a coating layer covering the spheroid portion and the foot portion.

[0019] In a thirteenth aspect of the pet toy in accordance with the twelfth aspect, the coating layer includes liquid rubber that is applied and cured to the spheroid portion and the foot portion.

[0020] A fourteenth aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a method of manufacturing a pet toy. The method comprises bonding a first polyurethane foam to a second

polyurethane foam to form a core body of the pet toy. The method further comprises coating a rubber coating layer over an exterior surface of the core body. The method further comprises curing the rubber coating layer.

[0021] In view of the state of the known technology, another aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a pet toy comprising a spheroid portion and a foot portion. The foot portion is integrally attached to the spheroid portion. The foot portion has a flat surface that forms a stand for the spheroid portion.

[0022] In view of the state of the known technology, another aspect of the present disclosure is to provide a method of manufacturing a pet toy. The method comprises mating a first polyurethane foam to a second polyurethane foam to form a core body of the pet toy having a cavity therebetween. The method further comprises coating a rubber coating layer over an exterior surface of the core body. The method further comprises curing the rubber coating layer over the core body.

[0023] The pet toy of the present disclosure provides an improved pet toy that is durable, yet soft and light. Further, the pet toy of the present disclosure is configured to enable the user to position the pet toy in an upright position without the use of hands, e.g., by using the user's foot instead. Thus, the user can avoid touching the pet toy with their hands when the pet toy has slobber or other materials on the surface thereof.

[0024] Also other objects, features, aspects and advantages of the disclosed pet toy will become apparent to those skilled in the art from the following detailed description, which, taken in conjunction with the annexed drawings, discloses one embodiment of the pet toy.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0025] Referring now to the attached drawings which form a part of this original disclosure:

[0026] FIG. 1 is a plan view of a pet toy in a user environment in accordance with an illustrated embodiment;

[0027] FIG. 2 is a view of the pet toy of FIG. 1 being operated by the user;

[0028] FIG. 3 is a view of the pet toy of FIGS. 1 and 2 in an upright state;

[0029] FIG. 4 is a side elevational view showing a first side of the pet toy;

[0030] FIG. 5 is a side elevational view showing a second side the pet toy;

[0031] FIG. 6 is a side elevational view showing a third side of the pet toy;

[0032] FIG. 7 is a side elevational view showing a fourth side of the pet toy;

[0033] FIG. 8 is a top perspective view of the pet toy;

[0034] FIG. 9 is a top plan view of the pet toy;

[0035] FIG. 10 is a bottom perspective view of the pet toy;

[0036] FIG. 11 is a bottom plan view of the pet toy;

[0037] FIG. 12 is another bottom perspective view of the pet toy;

[0038] FIG. 13 is another bottom perspective view of the pet toy;

[0039] FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 14-14 of FIG. 5;

[0040] FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 15-15 of FIG. 6;

[0041] FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 16-16 of FIG. 6;

[0042] FIG. 17 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 17-17 of FIG. 4;

[0043] FIG. 18 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 18-18 of FIG. 9; and

[0044] FIG. 19 is a cross-sectional view of the pet toy taken along and in the direction of lines 19-19 of FIG. 9.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0045] Selected embodiments will now be explained with reference to the drawings. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art from this disclosure that the following descriptions of the embodiments are provided for illustration only and not for the purpose of limiting the invention as defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

[0046] Referring to FIGS. 1 to 7 and 14 to 18, a pet toy 10 is illustrated in accordance with an embodiment. As best seen in FIGS. 14 to 18, the pet toy 10 comprises a core body 12 and a coating layer 14. The core body 12 comprises a spheroid portion 16 and a foot (or feet) portion, as best seen in FIGS. 1 to 7. Specifically, the spheroid portion 16 of the core body 12 has a prolate spheroidal shape with a pointy tip and a polar radius that is greater than an equatorial radius. In the illustrated embodiment, the coating layer 14 covers the core body 12. That is, the coating layer 14 covers both the spheroid portion 16 and the foot portion 18, as seen in FIGS. 14 to 18. Therefore, in the illustrated embodiment, the core body 12 can be considered a substrate for the coating layer 14 as will be further explained below.

[0047] In the illustrated embodiment, the pet toy 10 has an outer surface with an overall shape that is similar to that of an American football (i.e., a prolate spheroid). As can be understood, similar to an American football "kickoff", the pet toy 10 is designed to be kicked by the user to induce the pet to chase after the toy so that the user does not need to pick up the pet toy 10, as shown in FIGS. 1 to 3. The outer surface of the spheroid portion 16 preferably includes one or more outer groove(s) 20 to enhance aerodynamic performance of the pet toy 10, as best seen in FIGS. 4 to 10. The groove(s) 20 also reduces weight while maintaining the spheroidal shape of the pet toy 10. The groove(s) 20 can also help a user or a pet to pick up the pet toy 10, by providing an area for fingers or teeth to grip. In the illustrated embodiment, the groove(s) 20 forms a single continuous channel along an exterior (the outer surface) of the spheroid portion 16 that meanders around the outer surface with an overall serpentine-like shape. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in the pet products field from this disclosure that the pet toy 10 can include additional grooves of different shapes and designs.

[0048] In the illustrated embodiment, the pet toy 10 preferably has a first primary color (e.g., orange) that is applied to a majority of the pet toy 10, and a second color that is applied to the groove. That is, the pet toy 10 has the first primary color except for the groove 20 which has the second primary color (e.g., blue).

[0049] As best seen in FIGS. 4 to 13, the foot portion 18 is integrally formed with the spheroid portion 16. The foot portion 18 has a flat surface that forms a stand for the pet toy 10 (see for example, FIGS. 10 to 13). That is, the foot portion 18 is considered to be a stand or a base for the spheroid portion 16 so that the spheroid portion 16 is capable of standing upright. Therefore, the spheroid portion 16 can stand upright as supported on the foot portion 18 so that the pet toy 10 can stand upright without being supported by a

user or other device. In other words, the foot portion **18** can act as an integral tee to position the spheroid portion **16** in an upright manner for kicking. As can be understood, the integral tee enables a user to kick the pet toy **10** in a similar manner to an American football “kickoff”.

[0050] As seen in FIGS. **2** and **3**, the user can use a foot or feet to move the pet toy **10** into the upright position. That is, the pet toy **10** is configured and designed such that the user does not need to use hands to set the pet toy **10** to stand upright. The user can then kick the pet toy **10** like a football so that the pet toy **10** is a chase toy for the pet to pursue. Therefore, the user can launch the pet toy **10** without having to touch the pet toy **10** with his hands.

[0051] In one embodiment, the movement of the pet toy **10** into the upright position can be accomplished since the pet toy **10** has a plurality of fins **18A** that are opposed to each other. For example, as best seen in FIGS. **11** to **13**, the foot portion **18** includes three fins **18A** (or feet) extending from the spheroid portion **16**. That is, the foot portion **18** is a tripod stand that provides a balanced and strong base for the spheroid portion **16** to rest on in the upright position. The tripod base design of the foot portion **18** enables at least two contact points at the foot portion **18** with the ground at all times. That is, at least two fins **18A** will always make contact with the ground when setting the pet toy **10** into the upright position. The foot portion **18** is also designed for the user to contact or grab while a pet is holding the spheroid portion **16**. Therefore, the pet toy **10** is designed to be anti-slobber because the user can hold the foot portion **18** and/or the groove **20** of the spheroid portion **16**. It will be apparent to those skilled in the pet products field from this disclosure that the foot portion **18** can include different numbers of fins **18A** having varying shapes and sizes to form the stand of the pet toy **10**.

[0052] In this embodiment, the foot portion **18** has a center C_F . Center-lines C_L of the fins **18A** extending radially outward from the center C_F are spaced apart from one another by an angle α that is approximately 120 degrees to form the tripod stand. Each fin **18A** is spaced apart from the adjacent fin **18A** as measured in an annular direction where the annular direction is centered about the center C_F . Each fin **18A** is further spaced apart from the adjacent fin **18A** in the annular direction by an angle β . Each fin **18A** has an annular width corresponding to the angle σ whose center is also the center C_F . As shown in FIG. **11**, the angle σ is greater than the angle β . In other words, each fin **18A** has an annular width that is greater than the annular distance between adjacent ones of the fins **18A**. Thus, when the pet toy is lying on the ground, as shown in FIG. **2**, two of the three fins **18A** contact the ground and a third fin **18A** extends in an upward position. As shown in FIG. **3**, this upward position of one of the fins **18A** enables the user to easily locate and step on the upright fin **18A** to right the pet toy **10** into a kicking position. In other words, the upright fin **18A** can act as a lever to rotate the pet toy **10** around the two fins **18A** contacting the ground to easily right the pet toy **10**. This configuration of the three fins **18A** enables the user to easily right the pet toy without touching the pet toy **10** (which may have slobber thereon) and without the need to bend over to grab the pet toy **10**. Thus, the pet toy **10** is significantly improved relative to a conventional pet toy, and can prolong enjoyment by the user and the pet while reducing possible fatigue by the user.

[0053] In the illustrated embodiment, the core body **12** of the pet toy **10** is made of a first material. In this embodiment, the first material includes polyurethane foam. More preferably, the first material is polyurethane foam. In this embodiment, the coating layer **14** is made of a second material that is different from the first material, as will be further described below.

[0054] Referring to FIGS. **15**, **16**, **18** and **19**, the core body **12** includes a first polyurethane foam **12A** and a second polyurethane foam **12B** that are bonded together. For example, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be fitted to each other by protrusions and corresponding receiving openings and/or channels, as seen in FIGS. **12** and **13**. The first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be held together by adhesive. Therefore, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** are mated together to form the core body **12**. As shown, the foot portion **18** also includes the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B**. Therefore, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** are mated together to form the foot portion **18**.

[0055] As best seen in FIGS. **15** to **18**, the core body **12** comprises a cavity **22** separating a portion of the first polyurethane foam **12A** and a portion of the second polyurethane foam **12B** in the spheroid portion **16**. That is, the cavity **22** separates the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** in the spheroid portion **16** to reduce weight. The first polyurethane foam **12A** is formed having a first concavity **22A**. The second polyurethane foam **12B** is formed having a second concavity **22B** that mates with or is coupled to the first concavity **22A** to form the cavity **22**. The pet toy **10** having the cavity **22** creates a pet toy **10** that is lightweight, since a significant portion of the interior volume lacks material.

[0056] The pet toy **10** preferably has a total volume of approximately 1.5 liters. The cavity **22** of the pet toy **10** preferably has a volume of 0.385 liters. That is, the pet toy **10** preferably has an empty volume of approximately 0.385 liters. Therefore, the combined volume of the coating layer **14** and the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** is preferably 1.147 liters. That is, the combined volume first and second materials of the pet toy **10** is approximately 1.147 liters. It has been found that the ratio the volume of the cavity **22** to the overall volume of the pet toy **10** results in a pet toy **10** that maintains an overall structural rigidity that enables the pet toy **10** to be kicked by a user or bitten by a pet without permanently deforming, while simultaneously reducing the weight of the pet toy **10**. It will be apparent to those skilled in the pet products field from this disclosure that the volume values of these components can vary while maintaining a desired ratio of the different volume values with respect to each other.

[0057] As shown in FIGS. **15** and **16**, the foot portion **18** is devoid of the cavity **22** that separates the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B**. Therefore, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** contact each other continuously through the foot portion **18** but not through the core body **12**. In this way, the foot portion **18** has a first density of the pet toy **10** and the spheroid portion **16** has a second density of the pet toy **10**. In the illustrated embodiment, the first density is greater than the second density. That is, the foot portion **18** is denser than the core body **12** of the pet toy **10**.

[0058] In the illustrated embodiment, the pet toy **10** can have an overall density similar to that of a football. For example, the pet toy **10** can have an overall density of 0.1 g/cm^3 considering an approximate weight of about 410 to 460 grams and an approximate density of air is 1.2 kg/m^3 . In the illustrated embodiment, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** preferably together have a combined weight of approximately 190 grams. In the illustrated embodiment, the coating layer **14** preferably has a total weight of approximately 210 grams. Therefore, the second material preferably weighs more than the first material in the illustrated embodiment.

[0059] In the illustrated embodiment, the preferred density ratio of the first material to the second ratio is 0.2 to 1.2. That is, the preferred density of the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** together is preferably approximately 0.2. The preferred density of the coating layer **14** is preferably approximately 1.2 g/cm^3 . It will be apparent to those skilled in the pet products field from this disclosure that the density values of these components can vary while maintaining a desired ratio of the different density values with respect to each other.

[0060] In the illustrated embodiment, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be a sprayed polyurethane foam having a closed cell structure and is water resistant. The first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can alternatively include foam rubber made using small amounts of blowing agents to produce a less dense foam structure with better cushioning and energy absorption or thermal insulation.

[0061] The first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be made more flexible for energy absorption, or more rigid such as having polyisocyanurate (polyiso) foams as needed and/or desired. Preferably, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** are made to be flexible, deformable and lightweight. Additionally, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be made of thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU) that is highly elastic, flexible and resistant to abrasion, impact and weather. The first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** can be formed by extrusion, injection molding (e.g., reaction injection molding), blow and/or compression molding.

[0062] The core body **12** preferably has a surface that is textured to help catch the coating layer **14** or enable a secure attachment between the core body **12** and the coating layer **14**. That is, the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** preferably have micro dimples (not shown) that can receive the material of the coating layer **14**. However, the core body **12** is preferably smooth to the naked eye.

[0063] As stated, the coating layer **14** includes the second material that is applied to the core body **12**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second material includes liquid rubber that is applied and cured to the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B**. That is, the coating layer **14** includes liquid rubber that is applied and cured to the spheroid portion **16** and the foot portion **18**. The second material is bonded to the first material inside a mold with appropriate heat and pressure using a compression molded machine. In this way, the coating layer **14** is applied to the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second material comprises the coating material **14**.

[0064] The second material can include elastic coatings that can protect the first and second polyurethane foams **12A**

and **12B** from surface degradation, inhibit moisture vapor transmission, enhance aesthetics and to increase the impact and abrasion resistance of the pet toy **10**. The second material can be an above-grade exterior coating that is thicker than paint that is also a flexible coating that helps waterproof the exterior of the pet toy **10**. When the liquid rubber of the second material is applied to the core body, the coating layer **14** is formed, is cured, dried, hardened and bonded to the core body **12**, while remaining flexibility so that the pet toy **10** has a durable and a deformable structure that can retain its shape and consistency through multiple uses.

[0065] Examples of the second material that can form the coating layer **14** include elastic coatings such as acrylic, butyl rubber, chlorosulfonated polyethylene rubbers, poly-chloroprene rubbers, silicone polymer elastomeric coatings, polyurethane elastomer, modified asphalt, etc. In the illustrated embodiment, the first material has a first density, and the coating layer **14** has a second density that is greater than the first density. That is, the coating layer **14** can be denser than the core body **12** in the illustrated embodiment.

[0066] In the illustrated embodiment, the pet toy **10** is manufactured by a method comprising forming the first polyurethane foam **12A** and the second polyurethane foam **12B**. In particular, the method can comprise forming the first polyurethane foam **12A** using a chemical foaming process inside an appropriate mold using an injection molding machine. The second polyurethane foam **12B** can also be formed using a similar chemical foaming process inside another appropriate molding using the injection molding machine. As stated, the first polyurethane foam **12A** and the second polyurethane foam **12B** can alternatively be formed by extrusion, injection molding (e.g., reaction injection molding), blow and/or compression molding.

[0067] The method further comprises forming the coating layer **14** (e.g., the second material) by compression molding the rubber skin of the coating layer **14** inside a mold using a rubber molding machine. The method further comprises bonding or mating the first polyurethane foam **12A** to the second polyurethane foam **12B** to form the core body **12** of the pet toy **10**. The method further comprises applying a rubber coating layer **14** over an exterior surface of the core body **12**. Therefore, the method further comprises bonding the coating layer **14** to the first and second polyurethane foams **12A** and **12B** inside a mold with heat and pressure using a compression molding machine. The method further comprises curing the rubber coating layer **14** over the core body **12**.

[0068] The pet toy of the present disclosure provides an improved pet toy that is durable, yet soft and light. Further, the pet toy of the present disclosure enables the user to position the pet toy in an upright position without the use of hands, e.g., by using a foot. Thus, the user avoids touching the pet toy with their hands when the pet toy has slobber or other materials on the surface thereof.

General Interpretation of Terms

[0069] In understanding the scope of the present invention, the term “comprising” and its derivatives, as used herein, are intended to be open ended terms that specify the presence of the stated features, elements, components and/or groups, but do not exclude the presence of other unstated features, elements, components and/or groups. The foregoing also applies to words having similar meanings such as

the terms, “including,” “having” and their derivatives. Also, the terms “part,” “section,” “portion,” “member” or “element” when used in the singular can have the dual meaning of a single part or a plurality of parts.

[0070] The term “configured” as used herein to describe a component, section or part of a device that is constructed to carry out the desired function.

[0071] The terms of degree such as “substantially,” “about” and “approximately” as used herein mean a reasonable amount of deviation of the modified term such that the end result is not significantly changed.

[0072] While only selected embodiments have been chosen to illustrate the present invention, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art from this disclosure that various changes and modifications can be made herein without departing from the scope of the invention as defined in the appended claims. For example, the size, shape, location or orientation of the various components can be changed as needed and/or desired. Components that are shown directly connected or contacting each other can have intermediate structures disposed between them. The functions of one element can be performed by two, and vice versa. The structures and functions of one embodiment can be adopted in another embodiment. It is not necessary for all advantages to be present in a particular embodiment at the same time. Every feature which is unique from the prior art, alone or in combination with other features, also should be considered a separate description of further inventions by the applicant, including the structural and/or functional concepts embodied by such feature(s). Thus, the foregoing descriptions of the embodiments according to the present invention are provided for illustration only, and not for the purpose of limiting the invention as defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

What is claimed is:

1. A pet toy comprising:
 - a body having a center; and
 - a foot portion coupled to and extending from the body, the foot portion including:
 - a plurality of fins coupled to the body and extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the body, each of the plurality of fins having a distal end adapted to contact a support surface when the pet toy is positioned in a substantially upright position relative to a support surface, the plurality of fins being arranged and dimensioned so that a force applied user's foot to at least one fin of the plurality of fins is configured to cause the pet toy to move from a non-upright position to the substantially upright position.
2. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins includes a rounded corner.
3. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein the plurality of fins include three fins, wherein a first fin and a second fin are adapted to contact a support surface with the pet toy in the non-upright position, wherein a third fin is extending upward in a substantially vertical direction with the pet toy in the non-upright position.
4. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein a first fin of the plurality of fins is angularly spaced apart from a second fin of the plurality of fins by approximately 120 degrees.
5. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein the body includes:
 - a first foam portion;

- a second foam portion coupled to the first foam portion; and

- a cavity defined between the first foam portion and the second foam portion.

6. The pet toy of claim 5, wherein the first foam portion and the second foam portion extend from the body into the foot portion.

7. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein the foot portion includes a recessed surface extending along a first plane, wherein the distal end of each fin of the plurality of fins intersects a second plane, the second plane offset from the first plane, the distal end of each fin of the plurality of fins configured to contact a support surface with the pet toy in the substantially upright position.

8. The pet toy of claim 1, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins includes an angular annular width that is greater than an angular annular distance between adjacent fins of the plurality of fins.

9. A pet toy comprising:

- a spheroid portion having a center; and

- a foot portion integrally coupled to the spheroid portion, the foot portion including:

- a plurality of fins coupled to the spheroid portion, the plurality of fins extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the spheroid portion and defining a recessed surface therebetween, each fin of the plurality of fins including a distal end extending away from the recessed surface, wherein the distal ends of a first fin and a second fin of the plurality of fins are adapted to contact a support surface with the pet toy in an non-upright position, wherein a third fin of the plurality of fins is arranged and dimensioned to extend substantially upward with the pet toy in the non-upright position, the third fin adapted to receive a force applied by a user's foot to move the pet toy from the non-upright position to a substantially upright position.

10. The pet toy of claim 9, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins includes a rounded corner.

11. The pet toy of claim 9, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins includes a top end coupled to the spheroid portion, the top ends defining a first plane, wherein the distal ends of the plurality of fins define a second plane, wherein the recessed surface is positioned closer to second plane than to the first plane.

12. The pet toy of claim 9, wherein the distal ends of the plurality of fins define a plane, wherein the recessed surface substantially parallel to the plane.

13. The pet toy of claim 9, wherein the first fin of the plurality of fins is angularly spaced apart from the second fin of the plurality of fins by approximately 120 degrees.

14. The pet toy of claim 9, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins has an angular annular width that is greater than an angular annular distance between adjacent fins.

15. A method of manufacturing a pet toy comprising:

- forming a body of the pet toy, the body having a center; and

- forming a foot portion integrally coupled to the body, the foot portion forming a stand for the body to position the pet toy in a substantially upright position relative to a support surface, the foot portion including:

- a plurality of fins coupled to the body and extending substantially radially out from a line passing through the center of the body, each of the plurality of fins

having a distal end adapted to contact a support surface when the pet toy is positioned in the substantially upright position, the plurality of fins being arranged and dimensioned so that a force applied by a user's foot to at least one fin of the plurality of fins is configured to cause the pet toy to move from a non-upright position to the substantially upright position.

16. The method of claim **15**, wherein the foot portion includes a recessed surface positioned between the plurality of fins, wherein a top end of each fin of the plurality of fins is coupled to the body, the top ends defining a first plane, wherein the distal ends of the fins define a second plane, wherein the recessed surface is positioned closer to second plane than to the first plane.

17. The method of claim **15**, wherein the foot portion includes a recessed surface positioned between the plurality of fins, wherein the distal ends of the fins define a plane, wherein the recessed surface substantially parallel to the plane.

18. The method of claim **15**, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins includes a rounded corner.

19. The method of claim **15**, wherein each fin of the plurality of fins has an angular annular width that is greater than an angular annular distance between adjacent fins.

20. The method of claim **15**, wherein forming the body includes coupling a first foam portion to a second foam portion to form the body, wherein the body includes a cavity positioned between the first foam portion and the second foam portion.

* * * * *